

Platner wins easily, shifts focus to Collins

His margin of victory after recent allegations could be revealing

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

BLUE HILL, Maine — Graham Platner, the combat veteran and oyster farmer virtually unknown outside this corner of Maine a year ago, officially clinched the Democratic nomination in the state's US Senate primary election Tuesday night, according to the Associated Press.

Though Platner's meteoric political rise has been improbable, the outcome was a foregone conclusion as he faced minimal opposition after his only serious rival among Democrats, Governor Janet Mills, suspended her Senate campaign in April.

But with Platner rocked by damaging allegations in recent weeks, his margin of victory will provide a measure of his political resilience. Mills's name was still on the primary ballot, and some Democrats here still withheld support despite Platner's being the presumptive nominee.

At Platner's election night party in Blue Hill, the Downeast town where he was born, supporters chattered about vote margins while homemade signs that said "shuck the oligarchy" were displayed on walls alongside photos from Platner's many events across the state during the primary.

Taking the stage with his wife, Amy Gertner, the candidate stood behind a lectern bearing a

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Researchers say NIH situation is worsening

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

One year after hundreds of National Institutes of Health employees publicly accused the Trump administration of politicizing biomedical research in what they called the "Bethesda Declaration," staff members on Tuesday issued a new warning that conditions have only worsened.

The group cited political interference in grant-making, loss of staffing, and policy changes that local researchers say are affecting Massachusetts universities and the state's economy.

The NIH is the world's largest public funder of biomedical research, and Massachusetts receives the largest share per capita of that funding, about \$478 for each resident in 2025.

The new 38-page report, dubbed "Bethesda Declaration: One Year Later," lays out nine ways in which they say current NIH policies are hindering the agency's work, including: slowing medical research, worsening health inequities, weakening ethical safeguards, undermining public trust, driving away experienced staff, sidelining employee input, creating administrative hurdles, disrupting international collaborations, and contributing to low morale within the agency.

It was authored by 71 current and former

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'He's a master of the universe'

Rob Griffin, at the pinnacle of Boston's real estate scene, faces a suit by 2 colleagues

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

He's rarely quoted by name in the news media. His most recent local political donation was eight years ago. But in the four-plus decades since Rob Griffin emerged onto Boston's high-octane commercial real estate scene, he's become one of the most influential figures in the city — both in business and philanthropy.

Few know that better than Edward "Woody" Maher and Matthew Pullen, two longtime colleagues who

recently filed a bombshell breach-of-contract lawsuit against their business partner and their brokerage firm, Newmark.

News of the lawsuit — which Griffin's attorney, Paul Popeo, decried as "entirely without merit" — landed with seismic impact. Griffin, Maher, and Pullen are the backbone of a team responsible for crafting some of the biggest real estate deals in the region over the past half-century. Throughout Griffin's career, his team has brokered more than 1,000 deals

— sales of buildings and land worth \$140 billion all told.

Jennifer Schultz, a real estate lawyer and partner with Nixon Peabody in Boston, described "Griff," as he's widely known, succinctly.

"He's a master of the universe," she said.

Silver haired with a ready smile, Griffin cuts the portrait of a consummate power broker: deft, intelligent, with an unrivaled contact list and the sharp elbows it takes to thrive for decades in the world of top-dollar com-

mercial real estate — both in Boston and, increasingly, across the US.

Griffin and members of his family have also established themselves among Boston's philanthropic elite following great personal tragedy. After Griffin's 27-year-old son unexpectedly died in 2014, Griffin's family launched the Corey C. Griffin Charitable Foundation to support children from "under-resourced communities" — "Corey's Kids" — throughout the region. The founda-

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'We are stressed. We wait, we hope for something good to happen.'

MARCKENSON GILLES

A FAMILY ON THE BRINK



Haitians with protected status fear Supreme Court will allow Trump to terminate it

By Giulia McDonnell
Nieto del Rio

GLOBE STAFF

For Lusenie Jean and Marckenson Gilles, it's the question on their minds all the time: when their sons leave for school in the morning, while Gilles works his overnight shift, after Jean puts the children to bed.

Will the Supreme Court let the Trump administration end the humanitarian program that has allowed them to build their lives here? They know the decision, expected in the next month or so, will change their lives irrevocably.

"We are stressed. We wait, we hope for something good to happen," Gilles said in French.

The couple, who live in Ja-



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Top, Marckenson Gilles walked with his son Owen in their Jamaica Plain neighborhood. The possibility of displacement weighs on them. Above, 18-month-old Kerlee.

maica Plain with their three children, are able to lawfully reside and work in the United States because of the Temporary Protected Status program for Haitians. Some 330,000 Haitians across the country are living here legally under the program, which was created to help people from countries undergoing violent conflict, environmental catastrophes, or other dangerous conditions, and shields them from deportation. It was opened to Haitians after the earthquake that devastated the country in 2010.

But the Trump administration is fighting to terminate TPS, which it says was never meant to be permanent, and the

TPS, Page A7



VOL. 309, NO. 161

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Fan appreciation

Wednesday: Heating up again.
High 84-89. Low 65-70.

Thursday: Still hot, with storms around.
High 85-90. Low 66-71.

Sunrise: 5:07 a.m. Sunset: 8:20 p.m.

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

Attack of the \$30 sandwiches

Are they worth it? Food writer Devra First doesn't need much convincing (at left, chipotle pastrami at Sam La Grassa's). **G1.**

The United States launched retaliatory strikes against Iran, in what it called a proportional response to the shooting down of a US helicopter gunship. **A3.**

Governor Maura Healey said she'd support lifting a ban on happy hour, which has been illegal for decades. **B1.**

Three MBTA bus routes will remain free to ride through the end of the year, just weeks before the pilot program was again set to run out of funding. **B1.**

The health risks of alcohol start at a single drink a day, according to a new study that drew the ire of the alcohol industry. **A2.**

Pushback slows towns' efforts to phase out nicotine sales

By Bryan Hecht
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In the nearly five years since Brookline put a lifetime ban on nicotine and tobacco sales for young adults, similar policies have spread to roughly two dozen other Massachusetts communities.

But support is waning.

Local health boards are increasingly forgoing efforts to enact similar "Nicotine-Free Generation" regulations, policies that prohibit people born after a certain date from ever purchasing cigarettes and other nicotine products, regardless of their age.

While more cities and towns than ever have fielded regulatory proposals this

year, most have punted on the issue as they wait to see whether the movement can build more steam regionally and among state lawmakers.

Pushback from the tobacco and convenience store industries has also mounted, with local business owners packing health board meetings to oppose the regulations.

So far, the resistance is working, said Bob Collett, director of Barnstable County's Tobacco Control Program, where birth date ban initiatives have increasingly become "a difficult sell."

"A strong tobacco lobby is . . . doing a great job at instilling fear in the retailers around adopting this particular initia-

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